11.4.3 Verifying client identity

The verification performed by Nginx is limited to checking that the client provided a certificate that was signed by one of the trusted CAs, and that any constraints specified in the certificates themselves are satisfied, such as the expiry time of the certificate. To verify the identity of the client and apply appropriate permissions, the ingress controller sets several HTTP headers that you can use to check details of the client certificate, shown in table 11.2.

Table 11.2 HTTP headers set by Nginx

Header	Description
`ssl-client-verify`	Indicates whether a client certificate was presented and, if so, whether it was verified. The possible values are `NONE` to indicate no certificate was supplied, `SUCCESS` if a certificate was presented and is valid, or `FAILURE:<reason>` if a certificate was supplied but is invalid or not signed by a trusted CA.
`ssl-client-subject-dn`	The Subject Distinguished Name (DN) field of the certificate if one was supplied.
`ssl-client-issuer-dn`	The Issuer DN, which will match the Subject DN of the CA certificate.
`ssl-client-cert`	If `auth-tls-pass-certificate-to-upstream` is enabled, then this will contain the full client certificate in URL-encoded PEM format.

Figure 11.5 shows the overall process. The Nginx ingress controller terminates the client's TLS connection and verifies the client certificate during the TLS handshake. After the client has authenticated, the ingress controller forwards the request to the backend service and includes the verified client certificate in the `ssl-client-cert` header.

> **WARNING** Nginx forwards the client certificate regardless of whether authentication was successful